

OCI Architect Professional Cheat Sheet

EXAM 1Z0-997-26 • HANDS-ON PERFORMANCE EXAM (HPE) +
MCQ

Compute

Compute Instances	Bare metal and VM instances, flexible shapes (custom OCPU/memory)
Instance Pools	Manage groups of instances from an instance configuration
Autoscaling	Scale instance pools on metrics or schedule
OKE	Managed Kubernetes service; node pools or virtual nodes
Container Instances	Run containers without managing servers or clusters
OCIR	Oracle Cloud Infrastructure Registry — Docker/OCI image registry
Functions	Serverless, container-native FaaS built on Fn Project
Ravello Cloud Svc	DISCONTINUED (2020) — legacy trap, do not select
Dedicated VM Host	Physical server dedicated to your tenancy's VMs only

Networking

VCN	Virtual Cloud Network — logically isolated private network
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Storage

Block Volume	Network-attached block storage; Balanced/Higher Perf/Lower Cost tiers
Boot Volume	Block storage backing an instance's OS disk
Object Storage	Regional, durable object storage — Standard and Archive tiers
Archive Storage	Lowest-cost tier; rehydration required before read (up to ~4 hrs)
File Storage (FSS)	Managed NFS file systems, scalable, shared across instances
Volume Groups	Group and back up multiple block/boot volumes consistently
Cross-Region Replication	Object Storage and Block Volume can replicate to a second region
Storage Gateway	Hybrid file gateway presenting Object Storage as NFS on-prem
Data Transfer Disk/Appliance	Physical device-based bulk data import into Object Storage

Database

Autonomous Database (Shared)	Self-driving, self-patching DB on shared Exadata infra; ATP/ADW workload types
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Subnets	Regional (default) or AD-specific; public or private
Security Lists / NSGs	Stateful/stateless traffic rules at subnet or VNIC level
Route Tables	Direct traffic out of a subnet toward gateways
Internet Gateway	Connects a VCN to the public internet
NAT Gateway	Outbound-only internet access for private subnets
Service Gateway	Private access to Oracle services (Object Storage, etc.) without internet
Dynamic Routing GW (DRG)	Hub for VCN peering, FastConnect, IPSec VPN, on-prem connectivity
Local/Remote Peering	LPG (same region) vs RPG (cross-region) VCN peering
FastConnect	Dedicated private connection to OCI — public/private VIF, partner or colo
Site-to-Site VPN	IPSec VPN over the public internet through the DRG
Load Balancer	Layer 7 flexible LB — public or private, SSL termination
Network Load Balancer	Layer 4, high-throughput, preserves source IP
DNS (Zone Mgmt)	Managed authoritative DNS, traffic steering policies
Traffic Management Steering	Failover, load balancing, geolocation DNS routing policies
WAF	Web Application Firewall — edge protection for public apps
DDoS Protection	Always-on protection included at no extra cost for public IPs

Security, Identity & Compliance

TAM (Legacy) Tenancy-wide users

Autonomous Database (Dedicated)	Runs on a private Exadata Infrastructure — isolation, custom maintenance windows
Exadata Cloud Service	Customer-managed DB on dedicated Exadata hardware
Base Database Service	VM/BM DB systems running standard Oracle Database
Data Guard	DR/HA replication — Max Availability, Max Performance, Max Protection modes
RAC (Real Application Clusters)	Active-active clustered DB across nodes; BM/Exadata shapes only
GoldenGate	Real-time data replication and change data capture
MySQL HeatWave	Fully managed MySQL with in-memory analytics accelerator
NoSQL Database Cloud	Managed, schema-flexible key-value/document database
Database Migration Svc	Online/offline migration into OCI database services

Governance & Management

Tagging Defined and free form

IAM (Legacy)	tenancy-wide users, groups, dynamic groups, policies
Identity Domains	Newer IAM layer — multiple domains per tenancy, federation, OAuth/SAML apps
Compartments	Logical partitions within one tenancy; policy inheritance flows down, not a separate account
Vault (KMS)	Manage and rotate encryption keys and secrets
Certificates Service	Issue, manage, and rotate TLS certificates
Cloud Guard	Detects misconfigurations and threats across the tenancy
Security Zones	Enforce security posture policies — blocks non-compliant actions outright
Security Advisor	Automated recommendations to harden a new tenancy
Bastion	Time-limited, restricted SSH/RDP access without a public IP or jump host
Data Safe	DB security posture — auditing, data masking, sensitive data discovery
Web App & API Protection	Combined WAF + bot management + API security

AI / Multicloud

OCI Generative AI	Managed access to foundation models (Cohere, Meta Llama, etc.)
OCI Data Science	Managed notebooks, model training and deployment
Oracle Database@AWS	Oracle DB (incl. Exadata) run inside AWS, OCI-managed — new 2026 Professional cert exists for this

Tags	Defined and free-form tags for cost tracking and automation
Budgets	Set spending thresholds and alerts across compartments
Cost Analysis	Visualize and break down usage/cost by tag, compartment, service
Organizations	Link multiple tenancies for centralized governance
Resource Manager	Managed Terraform — apply/plan/destroy stacks natively in OCI
CLI / SDKs	Command-line and language SDK access to OCI APIs
Console	Web UI to manage the tenancy
Quotas	Service limits per compartment/region, adjustable via request
Announcements	Tenancy-specific service health and maintenance notices

Observability & Management

Monitoring	Metrics collection, dashboards, alarms across OCI resources
Logging	Centralized log collection — service, custom, and audit logs
Logging Analytics	Machine learning-powered log search and analysis
Application Performance Monitoring (APM)	Distributed tracing and app performance insights
Events	Rule-based automation triggered by resource state changes
Notifications	Pub/sub messaging — email, SMS, PagerDuty, Slack, function triggers
Service Connector Hub	Pipe logs/metrics/events between OCI services

Oracle Database@Azure Same model, deployed inside Microsoft Azure

Oracle Database@Google Cloud Same model, deployed inside Google Cloud

Cloud at Customer OCI hardware/services deployed inside customer's own data center

without custom code

Stack Monitoring Monitor full-stack topology — DB, middleware, app layers together

Migration

Application Migration Migrate entire application stacks from on-prem or other clouds

Database Migration Online/offline DB migration into OCI, minimal downtime options

Zero-Downtime Migration Oracle-specific tool using Data Guard/GoldenGate under the hood

Cloud Migration Assessment Discovery and readiness assessment of on-prem workloads

EXAM SNAPSHOT

Exam Code	1Z0-997-26
Level	Professional
Format	HPE + MCQ
Length	90 Minutes
Questions/Tasks	50
Passing Score	68%
Cost	\$245 USD
Validity	24 months
Prerequisite	Architect Associate (held ✓)

EXAM DOMAINS

Cloud-Native Architecture Design ~15%

High Availability & DR ~16%

Security Architecture ~15%

Database Architecture	~17%
Multicloud & Hybrid	~12%
Workload Migration	~11%
Observability & Mgmt	~14%

WHERE AWS INSTINCTS MISLEAD YOU

Compartments ≠ Accounts/OUs. Logical partitions in one tenancy, not separate billing/account boundaries — policy inheritance flows differently than AWS Organizations SCPs.

Licensing is testable. BYOL vs. included, RAC, Exadata sizing show up as real architecture constraints — no AWS-cert equivalent.

Two IAM systems coexist. Legacy IAM vs. newer Identity Domains — know which a described tenancy uses before answering.

Scoring is partial-credit. HPE labs reward attempting every sub-task over polishing fewer — don't skip a hard step to save time.

DISCLAIMER

- Non-exhaustive — a study aid, not the official exam blueprint.
- Domain % weightings are estimated from Oracle's published domain list (order, not confirmed official percentages) — verify against Oracle's current exam page before finalizing study time allocation.
- Service list current as of Aug 2026; Oracle updates OCI services and exam content continuously with no advance notice.
- Grouped by primary function; order carries no weighting significance.